Interview and Evaluation Handbook

Brief interviewers, ask comparable questions, score against evidence and decide with a written reason.

How to use it. Give the first two pages to every interviewer before they meet a candidate. Use the rest to run the decision.

1. Principles

- [ ] Every interviewer knows the role, the competency they own and what a strong answer sounds like
- [ ] Interviewers write notes from what was said and shown, and keep opinions separate
- [ ] Everyone scores on their own before anyone discusses
- [ ] The same competencies are assessed the same way for every candidate for a role
- [ ] We decide on evidence of what the person can do in this role, not on pedigree or comfort

2. Interviewer briefing checklist

- [ ] I have read the role definition and the candidate's portfolio or resume
- [ ] I know which competency I own and the questions I will use
- [ ] I know what the candidate has been told about this conversation
- [ ] I have blocked time to write feedback within 24 hours
- [ ] I will not read other interviewers' feedback until I have submitted mine

3. Competencies and what each rating means

COMPETENCY	1 NOT YET	2 DEVELOPING	3 MEETS THE BAR	4 RAISES THE BAR
Craft and quality of work				
Problem framing and systems thinking				
Collaboration and communication				
Ownership and leadership for the level				
Learning and self-awareness				

Write a short anchor in each cell for your role and level before the first interview. Without anchors, ratings drift.

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4. Questions to start from

COMPETENCY	ASK	LISTEN FOR
Craft	Walk me through a piece of work you are proud of. What did you decide, and why?	Specific decisions, trade-offs, what they would change
Problem framing	Tell me about a time the brief turned out to be the wrong problem.	How they questioned it, who they involved, what changed
Collaboration	Describe a disagreement with a product or engineering partner. How did it end?	Respect, evidence used, what they learned
Ownership	What is something you improved that nobody asked you to?	Initiative, follow-through, impact beyond the task
Learning	What did you get wrong in the last year, and what did you do about it?	Honest account, changed behaviour

5. Notes that help the decision

What I saw and heard
Quotes and examples

What I am unsure about
What would I need to see?

My rating and why
Competency, 1 to 4, one reason

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6. The debrief

- [ ] Everyone has submitted feedback before the meeting starts
- [ ] We go competency by competency, starting with the least certain
- [ ] Each person states evidence first, then their rating
- [ ] We name the risks and how we could reduce them
- [ ] The hiring manager decides, and writes down the reason

7. Decision record

COMPETENCY	RATINGS	STRONGEST EVIDENCE	CONCERN
Craft			
Problem framing			
Collaboration			
Ownership			
Learning			

Decision, level and the reason in one paragraph

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